Answers (for marking)

1. **groaned**. Accept “crooked” only with a reason (it hung badly). Not a whole sentence.
2. 1 mark each, up to 2, for **different** points: he stopped at the gate · he said “I'll wait here” · he was kicking at the gravel (fidgeting/putting it off). *Same point twice scores once.*
3. Points: **brave / bold** (marched on, went in alone) · **impatient with Ben** (rolled her eyes) · **curious** (looked at the shadowy corner, didn't move) · **calm / keeps secrets** (says “Coming” but stays). **3** = two points, at least one with evidence; **2** = two points without evidence, or one with evidence; **1** = one point. Retelling with no describing word = 0.
4. Points: the ticking in the darkness, then it stops · nobody uses the shed · ivy “like a hand” · cold air, smell of old rain · Isla holds her breath · the story stops before we find out (“Not yet”). Marked like Q3. Do not accept “it is dark” on its own.
5. She will go and look in the corner / find what was ticking (1), because “she didn't move. Not yet.” or she looked at the corner where the sound had been (1).
6. It is old / not looked after / creepy, as if something is reaching or holding on.